

ReaCustomMenu Version 1.0.0

User Manual

Compatibility: Windows only

ReaCustomMenu is currently available for **Windows only**. There is currently no macOS or Linux version.

1. Introduction

ReaCustomMenu is a REAPER extension that allows you to create your own menus in REAPER's main menu bar.

The configuration is stored in a file called:

`ReaCustomMenu.xml`

Which can be modified using a simple text editor (like the Windows Notepad).

2. Installation

Installation simply consists of putting two files in the correct locations:

- `reaper_ReaCustomMenu.dll`
- `ReaCustomMenu.xml`

2.1 Finding the REAPER resource folder

The easiest way is to let REAPER open it for you.

1. Start REAPER.
2. In REAPER's main menu, click "Options".
3. In the menu that appears, click:
"Show REAPER resource path in explorer/finder"

Windows will automatically open the folder used by REAPER for its personal files.

This is the folder you need for the ReaCustomMenu installation.

3. Installing the DLL

In the folder that has just opened, look for a folder called:

`UserPlugins`

Open it.

Copying the DLL

Copy:

```
reaper_ReaCustomMenu.dll
```

into the UserPlugins folder.

You should end up with:

```
UserPlugins\reaper_ReaCustomMenu.dll
```

Do not place the DLL in REAPER's installation folder, such as C:\Program Files\REAPER.

It must be placed in the UserPlugins folder inside REAPER's resource folder.

4. Installing ReaCustomMenu.xml

Return to the REAPER resource folder that you opened in section 2.

It is **this folder**, not the UserPlugins folder, that must contain:

```
ReaCustomMenu.xml
```

Copy:

```
ReaCustomMenu.xml
```

directly into this folder.

You should end up with something similar to:

REAPER resource folder

```
|
|— ReaCustomMenu.xml
|
└─ UserPlugins
    |
    └─ reaper_ReaCustomMenu.dll
```

The names of the other files in the folder are not important.

5. Installation End

Close REAPER completely.

ReaCustomMenu reads ReaCustomMenu.xml when REAPER starts.

If the file is valid, the menus it contains will appear in REAPER's main menu bar.

If ReaCustomMenu.xml is not present or empty, no menus are created.

6. Menu Configuration

ReaCustomMenu uses a simple XML file to define the custom menus that should be created in REAPER's main menu bar.

You do not need to know XML to use ReaCustomMenu.

The `ReaCustomMenu.xml` file supplied with the software already contains the basic structure required.

6.1 Adding a menu

Open `ReaCustomMenu.xml` with a simple text editor, such as Windows Notepad.

Inside `<menus>`, add one `<mainmenu>` line for each menu you want to create.

For example:

```
<menus>

    <mainmenu name="Mixing" id="mixing"/>
    <mainmenu name="MIDI" id="midi"/>
    <mainmenu name="My Tools" id="tools"/>

</menus>
```

Each menu has two pieces of information:

- **name**: the name displayed in REAPER's main menu bar.
- **id**: a unique identifier used by REAPER to distinguish this menu from others.

The identifier can be chosen freely, but it must be different for each menu.

6.2 Customizing the menu contents

After saving the XML file, restart REAPER.

The new menus will then appear in REAPER's main menu bar.

From this point on, the menu contents can be fully customized directly in REAPER, using the standard menu editor:

Options → "Customize menus/toolbars"

You can add actions, scripts, separators and submenus, move them, rename them or delete them just as you would with REAPER's other menus.

Changes made in REAPER are automatically saved by REAPER and remain available on subsequent launches.

The XML file therefore mainly serves to **declare the menus that ReaCustomMenu should create**. The menu contents and customizations are then managed by REAPER itself.

6.3 Multiple menus

You can define as many top-level menus as needed:

```
<menus>
```

```
    <mainmenu name="Mixing" id="mixing"/>
```

```
    <mainmenu name="Instruments" id="instruments"/>
```

```
    <mainmenu name="MIDI" id="midi"/>
```

```
    <mainmenu name="Scripts" id="scripts"/>
```

```
</menus>
```

After restarting REAPER, each of these menus will be available in the main menu bar.

6.4 Modifying or removing a menu

To change a menu name, simply modify the `name` attribute in the XML file.

To remove a menu from ReaCustomMenu, remove its `<mainmenu>` line from the XML file.

Restart REAPER afterwards to apply the change.